KenTender Module Guide: Strategy

Oct 12, 2026

What Strategy is for

Strategy holds the entity's approved strategic plan, so that every planned purchase can name the objective it serves. It does not sit in the main chain of work. It feeds Procurement Planning from the side, alongside Departmental Needs: every item in the Annual Procurement Plan must serve one of its objectives.

The module is deliberately small. It does three things: it keeps the plan as a structured record, it controls who may change it and how a change becomes official, and it lets other modules read the approved version. It does not measure performance, set budgets, or run any part of procurement.

What it hands on: the objectives of the approved plan that applies to each financial year. When a planner puts an item in the Annual Procurement Plan, they must pick one of those objectives.

Why it matters: the plan is where the entity commits to its share of the national development goals in Kenya Vision 2030 and the Medium-Term Plans. Tying each purchase to an objective lets the entity show how its spending advances those goals, not just that the spending happened.

Who uses it

Two responsibilities do the work in Strategy: the Strategy Author and the Strategy Approver. Everyone else reads.

Who	What they can do
Strategy Author	Creates a plan, starts an update to the current plan, edits the structure, submits for approval, and corrects and resubmits after a return.
Strategy Approver	Reviews a submitted version, then approves it or returns it with a reason.

Who	What they can do
Auditor	Reads everything, including drafts, versions awaiting approval and the full history. Changes nothing.
Any other signed-in staff member (Accounting Officer, Head of Procurement Function, department heads, planners)	Reads approved plans: the current and previous versions, their structure and targets, and who approved them and why. Cannot see drafts or versions awaiting approval.
System administrators	Can read every record for support. Hold no business authority unless they are assigned it.
Suppliers and bidders	No access.

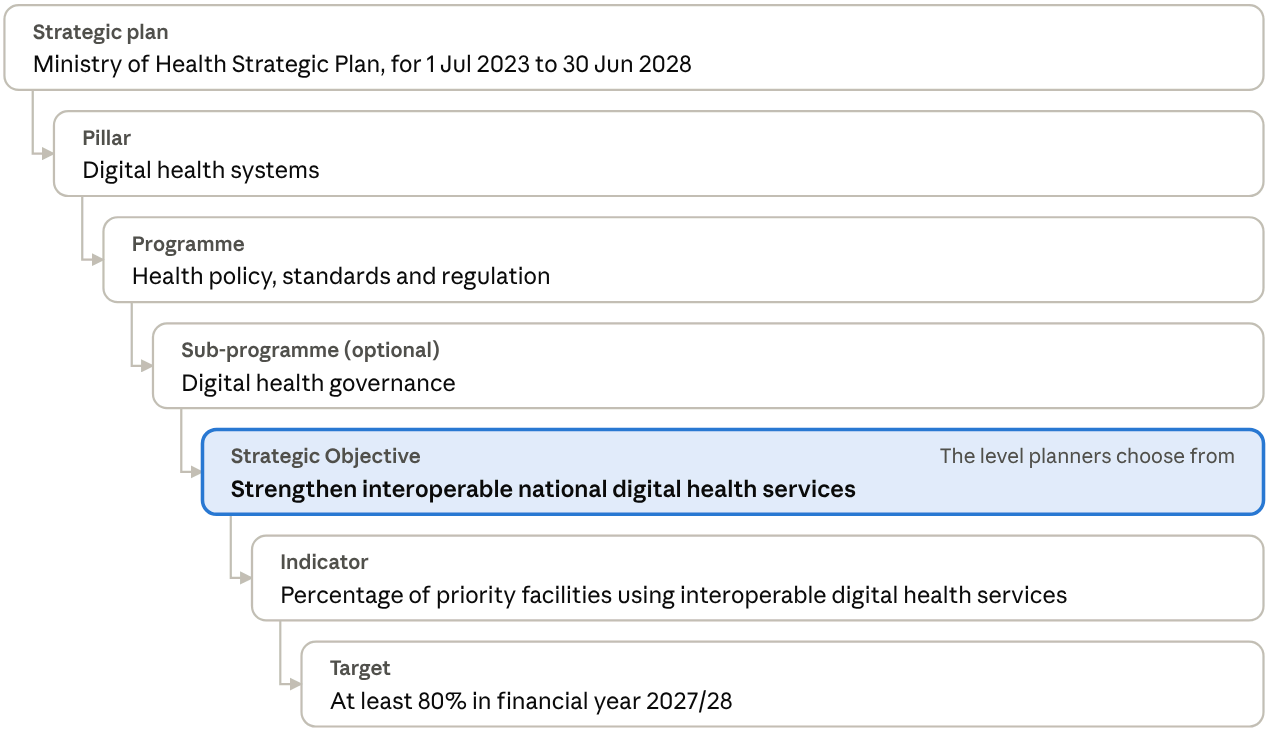
These responsibilities apply across the whole entity. Strategy is not split by department. A job title grants nothing here: the Accounting Officer cannot approve a plan unless they have also been assigned the Strategy Approver responsibility.

One person may hold both roles, but the system will not let them approve a version they submitted themselves. It checks this against the version's own history, so it cannot be bypassed by switching roles.

What a strategic plan contains

A plan is a tree of four kinds of building block, with measures attached at the bottom.

A plan runs from broad pillars down to measurable targets



plan structure · seven levels, Ministry of Health example

Each level has one job. Pillars and programmes organise the plan. A **strategic objective** states what the entity aims to achieve, and it is the only level a procurement planner can choose. An **indicator** says how progress on one objective is measured, with a full written definition and a unit. A **target** sets the expected value for one financial year or one date, as *at least*, *at most* or *equal to* a number.

A plan also carries a role and a period. Most entities have one **main strategic plan**. A narrower framework, such as one directorate's, can be recorded as a **supporting framework** attached to the main plan. Each plan covers a stated period, and each approved change to it is a numbered version.

How a plan moves from draft to approved

Every plan version is in one of four states: Draft, Awaiting approval, Current or Previous version. The only way to change an approved plan is to start a new version.



version lifecycle · four states, two loops

The journey, step by step:

1. **Create and build.** The Strategy Author records the plan's title, type and period, then builds its structure: pillars, programmes, objectives, indicators and targets.
2. **Submit.** The system checks that the plan is complete, and the version becomes read-only.
3. **Review.** The Strategy Approver sees first what has changed since the version it was based on, then the full proposed plan and its history.
4. **Decide.** The Approver either approves the version or returns it to the Author with a written reason. A returned version comes back as a Draft marked Changes requested, with its history kept. There is no outright rejection: a plan is either approved or sent back to be fixed.
5. **Update later.** To change an approved plan, the Author starts an update, which copies the current version into a new Draft. The current version stays in use until the update is approved and its start date has arrived.

Approving ahead of time. A version can be approved before its start date. It is then approved but not yet in use: the version already in use carries on until the new one's start date, and from that date the new version applies. This is how the next strategic plan, or a planned change to the current one, is settled in time for planners to choose its objectives when they prepare the coming year's procurement plan.

What the rest of the system takes from Strategy

Other modules can read approved strategy, but they cannot change it, and they never see a draft. Procurement Planning is the main user. It asks Strategy four questions, and Strategy answers each one from the approved record only.

What a module asks	What Strategy answers
Which strategic plan applies on this date or in this financial year?	The one main plan in force, plus any supporting frameworks if asked. If no plan covers the date, or two do, Strategy says so plainly and never picks one.
Which objectives can be chosen?	The objectives of the approved version that applies to that date or year, each with its full path from pillar down.
Where does this objective sit?	The path from the plan to the objective, indicator or target in question.
Keep a fixed copy of this objective for an approval.	A snapshot of the plan, the version and the path from pillar to objective. Asking again for the same approval returns the same snapshot.

How a plan item gets its objective. The planner opens an item in the Annual Procurement Plan. Planning finds the plan that applies to that financial year and lists its objectives. The planner picks exactly one. Indicators and targets stay visible under the objective but cannot be chosen instead.

What happens at approval. When the Procurement Plan is approved, Planning asks Strategy for a snapshot and stores it with the plan. If the strategic plan is revised later, the approved procurement plan keeps the objective details it was approved with. History is never rewritten.

In the laptops purchase. The Procurement Planner gives the combined laptops plan item the objective "Strengthen interoperable national digital health services". When the Annual Procurement Plan is approved, that objective and its place in the strategic plan are stored with the plan item, so every later step of the purchase can be traced back to it.

Safeguards

- **Authority comes from assignment.** Only someone assigned Strategy Author or Strategy Approver can change or approve a plan. A job title alone grants nothing.
- **No one approves their own work.** The person who submitted a version cannot approve it.
- **Approved plans are never edited.** A change is always a new version, reviewed and approved like the first. Once a version is submitted, nothing in it is deleted.
- **One main plan for any date.** Two main strategic plans can never apply to the same date, so planners are never left to guess which plan governs.
- **Only approved strategy is shared.** Drafts and versions awaiting approval stay with the Strategy roles and the Auditor. Other modules read approved strategy and cannot change it.
- **History is kept.** Every action is recorded with who took it, in what role, when and why. A procurement plan keeps the strategy details it was approved with, even after the strategic plan changes.